1 **4.6**
Internal and External Challenges to State Power

The English made them drunk and then cheated them in Bargains.
... John Easton, A narrative of the Causes Which led to Philip's Indian War, 1858

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3 **4.6 Internal and External Challenges to State Power**

- As empires developed and changed, many social, political, and economic groups resisted state expansion through a variety of challenges to state power.
- Some of these revolts occurred in the home of the empire.
- For example, the Fronde civil disturbances in France between 1648 and 1653 attempted to curb growing royal power.

4 **4.6 Internal and External Challenges to State Power**

- Other disturbances took place within colonies.
- For instance, Metacom's War (1675-1678), also called King Philip's War, was in part a result of English colonists using underhanded tactics in their continuing pressure to control Native American lands.

5 **I. Resistance to Portugal in Africa**

- By the 17th century, the Dutch and the English had pushed the Portuguese out of South Asia.
- The Portuguese looked to Africa, where it had carried out slave raids since the 15th century, to build a colony.
- In 1624, Ana Nzinga became ruler of Ndongo in south-central Africa (present day Angola).

6 **I. Resistance to Portugal in Africa**

- In addition to the slave raids by Portugal, other African peoples were attacking Ndongo.
- In exchange for protection from neighboring powers and an end to Portugal's raids, Nzinga became an ally of Portugal.
- Nzinga was baptized as Christian,

7 **I. Resistance to Portugal in Africa**

- However, the alliance broke down.
- Nzinga and her people fled west, taking over the state of Matamba .
- She then incited a rebellion in Ndongo, allied with the Dutch, and offered freedom in Matamba to enslaved Africans.
- Nzinga ruled for decades, building Matamba into an economically strong state.

8 **II. Local Resistance in Russia**

- In contrast to the Portuguese empire, pressures on state power came from within Russia, not outside of it.

- While conditions had improved for serfs in Western Europe by the 14th century, the same was not true for the serfs in Russia.
- Wars during the 14th and 15th centuries weakened the central government and increased the power of the nobility.

9 **II. Local Resistance in Russia**

- As demand for grain increased, nobles imposed harsh conditions on serfs.

- First, the Mongols and later the Russian princes collected heavy tribute and taxes (for services such as protection or to support the government's army) from the peasants.
- As a result, the peasants' debts increased, and over time more peasants lost their lands and were forced into serfdom.

10 **II. Local Resistance in Russia**

- The practice of serfdom benefited the government because it kept the peasants under control, regulated by the nobility.
- Serfdom also benefited the landowners because it provided free labor.

11 **II. Local Resistance in Russia**

- As Russian territory extended west to the Baltic and east to Siberia, the institution of serfdom expanded with it.
- An agricultural state, Russia kept serfs tied to the land long after practice had ended, practically if not legally in Western Europe.
- For example, Elizabeth I freed the last remaining serfs in England in 1574.
- In contrast, a law of 1649 chained Russian serfs to the lands where they were born and ensured their service to their landlords, who could buy and sell them and administer punishments.
- The village communities, called mirs, also controlled even the small landholders among the peasants.

12 **II. Local Resistance in Russia**

- Southwest of Moscow, near the Black Sea, peasants who were skilled fighters lived on the grassy, treeless steppes.
- Many were runaway serfs who lived in small groups, influenced by the ways of the neighboring nomadic descendants of the Mongols.
- These fierce Cossack warriors were sometimes at odds with the central, autocratic government of the tsars.
- However , these fiercely independent warriors could also be hired as mercenaries to defend "Mother Russia" against Swedish, Tatar, and Ottoman forces.
- The Cossacks were thus important in Russia's expansion to the Ural Mountains and farther east into Siberia.

13 **II. Local Resistance in Russia**

- A Cossack known as Yemelyan Pugachev began a peasant rebellion against Catherine the Great in 1774 for giving the nobility power over the serfs on their lands in exchange for political loyalty, leaving the peasants without ties or recourse to the state.
- Falsely claiming to be Catherine's murdered husband, Peter III, Pugachev gathered a following of discontented peasants, people from different ethnic groups, and fellow Cossacks.

- At one point, these groups controlled the territory between the Volga River and the Urals.

14 **II. Local Resistance in Russia**

- Within a year, though, the Russian army captured Pugachev and the Russian government executed him.
- The Pugachev Rebellion caused Catherine to increase her oppression of the peasants in return for the support of the nobles to help her avoid future revolts.

15 **III. Rebellion in South Asia**

- In the 16th and 17th centuries, the Mughal empire controlled much of what is now India and Pakistan.
- The Mughals centralized government and spread Persian art and culture as well as Islam.
- However, much of the population remained Hindu after attempts at conversion.
- The Maratha -a Hindu warrior group - fought the Mughals in a series of battles from 1680-1707.

16 **III. Rebellion in South Asia**

- They created the Hindu Maratha Empire.
- It lasted until 1818, effectively ending the Mughal rule of India.

17 **IV. Revolts in the Spanish Empire**

- Spain also experienced rebellions within its territories.
- The Pueblo Revolt took place in 1680 against the Spanish in what is now New Mexico.

18 **IV. Revolts in the Spanish Empire**

- The Pueblo and Apache, two indigenous groups, fought colonizers who were trying to force religious conversions.
- The indigenous people killed about 400 Spaniards, drove the rest out of the area, and destroyed churches.
- The Spanish re-conquered the area in 1692.

19 **V. Struggles for Power in England and its Colonies**

- England defeated Spanish colonists and took control of much of Jamaica in 1655.
- Enslaved people in the Caribbean and former Spanish territories in the Americas fought to gain freedom in what were known as Maroon Wars (1728-1740 and 1795-1796).

20 **V. Struggles for Power in England and its Colonies**

- Maroons were descendants of Africans who had escaped slavery in Jamaica.
  - They escaped their owners and formed independent settlements.
- Queen Nanny, herself had escaped slavery, united all the maroons of the island.
  - Jamaicans later recognized her as a national hero.

21 **V. Struggles for Power in England and its Colonies**

- Slave revolts were common in the Americas, especially in those locations where enslaved Africans

outnumbered free Europeans.

- The first recorded slave revolt in what is now the United States was the Gloucester County Rebellion in Virginia in 1663.
- In this rebellion, enslaved Africans and white indentured servants conspired together to demand their freedom from the governor.

22 **V. Struggles for Power in England and its Colonies**

- Stono Rebellion - a slave rebellion that began on 9 September 1739, in the colony of South Carolina. It was the largest slave uprising in the British mainland colonies

23 **V. Struggles for Power in England and its Colonies**

- Metacom's War, discussed earlier in this topic, was the final major effort of the indigenous people to drive the British from New England.
- The war spread throughout New England and resulted in the destruction of 12 towns.
- Some Native American groups, including the Mohegan and Pequot, sided with the English.
- Although Native American peoples continued to live in the region, the war ended with the subjugation of the Wampanoag people by the English colonists.

24 **V. Struggles for Power in England and its Colonies**

- Struggles for power took place within England as well.
- In 1685, James II became king. James was Catholic, and his anti-Protestant measures enraged many English people.

25 **V. Struggles for Power in England and its Colonies**

- A group of nobles invited William of Orange, who was James's nephew and son-in-law, to invade England with an army and became the new king.
- He agreed, landing in England in 1688. James fled to France.
- In 1689, William and his wife Mary II (James's daughter) began their joint rule of England.
- Both William and Mary were Protestant, and the English throne remained in Protestant hands after that.

26 **V. Struggles for Power in England and its Colonies**

- English people called this revolt the Glorious Revolution or the Bloodless Revolution.
- It strengthened the power of Parliament, which passed a law forbidding Catholics to rule England.
- That revolution took place without much violence, but religious tensions continued in England and throughout much of the world.

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